The AI Landscape Map

Models change every few months, so this map is organised by family personality, not version numbers.

The big picture: 3 kinds of players

Think of a **city**: **Model makers** build the engines (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google, Mistral, Meta). **Platforms** sell or host those engines (Microsoft Azure, AWS, Google Cloud, Oracle Cloud). **Apps** are what normal people touch (ChatGPT, Claude app, Copilot, Gemini app).

Closed vs open models

Closed (API only): you rent the model and can't see inside (GPT, Claude, Gemini). Easy and powerful, but your data goes to the provider.
Open-weight: you download and run it yourself (Mistral, Llama, DeepSeek, Qwen). More control and privacy, but you manage it.
Hook: closed = renting a taxi, open = owning a car.

The map

Family	Made by	Best known for	Typically used for	Typically used by
GPT	OpenAI	All-rounder, huge ecosystem, text + image + voice	General chat, content, assistants, automation	Individuals, startups, big companies (also via Microsoft products)
Claude	Anthropic	Careful writing, coding, long documents, safety focus	Coding help, document analysis, writing, enterprise assistants	Developers, writers, analysts, regulated industries
Gemini	Google	Multimodal (text, image, audio, video), very large context window	Huge documents or videos, Google Workspace help	Google ecosystem users, researchers, Google Cloud businesses
Mistral	Mistral AI (France)	Lean, efficient, many open-weight models	Cost-sensitive apps, running models in-house	Companies wanting data control, European organisations
Llama	Meta	Most popular open-weight family	Custom or fine-tuned models, self-hosting	Developers, researchers, companies building their own AI
DeepSeek / Qwen	Chinese labs	Strong open-weight models at low cost	Cheap reasoning and coding, self-hosting	Cost-focused developers and researchers
Grok	xAI	Tied to the X platform, real-time social data	Chat inside X	X users

Who uses AI for what? (by job)

Everyday people: questions, writing help, learning, trip planning. **Developers:** writing, debugging, reviewing code. **Analysts and business teams:** summarising reports, drafting emails, finding insights. **Customer support:** chatbots for common questions. **Researchers:** reading papers, brainstorming, data work. **Creative teams:** images, music, video and ideas (using tools like Midjourney).

How to choose (simple rules of thumb)

1. Easiest, most popular option? **GPT family.** 2. Careful long-document work or coding? **Claude family.**
3. Video, giant inputs, or you live in Google tools? **Gemini family.** 4. Privacy, low cost, or full control? **Open-weight (Mistral, Llama).**
Honest note: top models are close in quality and leapfrog each other constantly. The best one depends on your task, budget and data rules, so teams often try two or three before choosing.

> ***"GPT is the popular all-rounder, Claude is the careful thinker, Gemini is the Google multi-talent, and Mistral/Llama are the ones you can own."***